

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

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The Hearth's chicken, dancing in the rain with her umbrella and galoshes.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

63° / 51°

Thunderstorms

Sunrise 6:18 AM · Sunset 6:12 PM

Tomorrow — Cloudy, slight chance of morning rain; high 68, low 50

Overheard at the historic Oxbow Saloon — from a patron wringing out his cloak: "Why doesn't the Dragonborn just shout one of those clear skies of his, so a man can walk home dry?" The barkeep only shrugged: "He was here not ten minutes ago."

AROUND THE HOLDS · THE WEEK AHEAD

Two Fairs, One Hold: Fair Week Breaks Over the Rim



By the Dude — Payson, Ariz.



The village of the distant clans rises beneath storm-dark skies as the Hold readies its autumn revels.

Hail and well met, friend of the Hearth — pull your cloak tight and lean close to the hearth-fire, for the Nine have sent us a Tuesday of thunder over the Rim. The storm clouds massing above the pines are no dragon's wrath, but fair warning: today is a day for galoshes, not garb. Look past the rain, traveler, and you will see the

week ahead glitters like coin in a bard's cup — for this is Fair Week in the Hold, when the gates swing wide on the season's grandest revels. PAYSON — Thursday opens the 72nd annual Northern Gila County Fair & B.U.C.K.L.E. Festival at the Payson Event Center, three days of rodeo, bull riding, livestock shows, and wander-

ing minstrels. Friday the inaugural North Inch Renaissance Faire raises the banners of the far clans at the Payson Golf Club for a full weekend of artisans, combat demonstrations, and revelry. Two fairs, one weekend, one Hold — and a friendly rivalry is already brewing. The cowboys and the knights are sizing each other up across the lists, each swearing theirs is the grander revel, all in good cheer — though the old fair has hired Dwe-mer tinkers, and if their steam-engines get stoked, the weekend's revels may have to be judged by ear. The Scroll stays neutral in all matters of merriment: attend both, then judge. The days between brim with markets and music across the Holds — from Show Low to Prescott — with Prescott's Fall Arts & Crafts Show and Sedona's Sunday market crowning the weekend. A merry week to be a wayfarer, rain or shine.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY

-  **Pine**
 - **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — 7 AM–noon with PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction, off Hwy 87 just before Pine; help clear brush and roots for better trails and fire access, tools provided, RSVP trails@psfuelreduction.org.
-  **Show Low**
 - **Taco Tuesdays with Midnight Moon** — live music at Sal & Teresa's, 4 PM; tacos and tunes to carry you through the storm.
-  **Prescott**
 - **Line Dance Lessons** — 6 PM, 214 S. Montezuma St.; boot-scoot through the week in proper Whiskey Row style.

THE DAYS AHEAD

- **Wednesday, Sept. 30**
 - **Musicians with Heart Open Mic** — 7 PM, Jersey Lilly Saloon, Prescott. The weekly gathering on the Whiskey Row strip, where any local bard may claim the stage in a classic saloon — no coin at the door, and always a surprise or two.

- **Thursday, Oct. 1**

- **Northern Gila County Fair & B.U.C.K.L.E.**

- Festival** (Oct 1–3) — gates open 9 AM at the Payson Event Center & Mazatzal Event Center. The 72nd annual fair, “Growing Traditions Since 1955,” brings three days of western heritage, rodeo action — the cowboys, young riders who ride one beast to corral others, a trade unknown in Skyrim, where horses are bred for war and none has ever been fool enough to rope a mammoth — wandering merrymakers, and family fun, with the B.U.C.K.L.E. Festival's professional bull riding (Fri 6 PM, Sat 12:30 PM), ranch rodeo, barrel racing, mutton bustin’ — wherein the boldest small riders cling to sprinting sheep — livestock shows and the Junior Livestock Auction. Thursday evening honors local heroes and veterans, and the State Champion Fiddle Festival runs all weekend.

- **Windmill Park Farmers Market** — 2–6 PM, 9950 E. Cornville Rd., Cornville. A rain-or-shine Thursday market with produce, sourdough, honey, jams, and farm goods — worth the drive down through the pines.

- **Clay Springs Farmers Market** — 3 PM, Clay Springs Heritage Foundation near Show Low. A small hometown market of local produce and goods from the White Mountains.

• **Friday, Oct. 2**

— **North Inch Renaissance Faire** (Oct 2–4) — 9 AM, 1504 W. Country Club Drive, Payson. The inaugural faire of the far clans raises its banners at the Payson Golf Club — its folk hail from Scotland, a mist-shrouded realm across the eastern sea — and the bards already sing of it:

*Seven days he flew, six nights he sped,
where eastern winds the dragon led —
and landed on an isle, they say,
where Scotsmen pipe the night away!*

Artisans, combat, entertainment, and merry folk fill a recreated village of that far realm all weekend; garb optional. Each day wears its own colors: Friday the gates swing wide and every young squire and shield-maiden of eighteen winters or fewer enters free. Saturday the pirates take the village, and after dark a masquerade ball where the rum flows till nine. Sunday the enchanted realm descends, and the Queen of the Faeries holds court among the fae folk — think twice before tasting the fairy food — young Tam of Pine once ate a thimbleful and spent a quarter-hour as a dragonfly, buzzing the mead tent. A stranger came to town holding a queer device before him that wailed like a heartbroken mammoth, a clever wind-spell doing the breathing for him.

— **First Friday in the Galleries** — 4–7 PM, Tlaquepaque, Sedona. The monthly wander among the painters' halls, with music, tastings of the vineyard's finest, and treats — an evening stroll through the red-rock art scene.

— **The Locals Market** — 3 PM, Pinedale Public Library, between Show Low and Pinetop-Lakeside. A small community market with local traders and goods among the pines.

• **Saturday, Oct. 3**

— **Prescott Fall Arts & Crafts Show** (Oct 3–4) — Historic Yavapai County Courthouse Plaza. One of Prescott's most beloved autumn traditions: hundreds of artists, craftsmen, and provisioners take over the square for two days of shopping, wandering merrymakers, and small-town fall atmosphere.

• **Sunday, Oct. 4**

— **Sedona Community Farmers Market** — 8–11 AM, 2201 W. SR 89A, Sedona. The weekly Sunday market with local produce, baked goods, and artisan wares; arrive early, for it wraps by eleven.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Saturday — measure the flame bulb and socket, find or design a wall-torch sconce model, and slice in PETG (Arizona sun will warp PLA); print a small socket test piece first.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Due Saturday, Oct. 3 — print two torches plus the test piece, and test-fit the bulb and socket before any finishing work.

The Nine do not wait — the torch sconce designs stand overdue since Saturday.



The workshop bench readies the torches and the shield for the Hearth's doors.

THAT Brewery & Pub · Pine



The drive-by view on AZ-87, as the engraver saw it — the painted sign and truck mural out front.

Pine's own craft brewery and pub sits right on AZ-87, pouring a lineup of house ales — the light Backwoods Blonde, the Strawberry Blonde, the fruity Clearly That's Hazy IPA, the grapefruity Roadrash IPA, and a crisp Mexican Lager — alongside hearty pub fare. The elk burger is the legend of the house, and a frost-rune keeps the casks at cellar-cold even in the September heat, so every pint lands at the table impossibly cold.

“Great food, interesting beers, and a friendly vibe. Would recommend for anyone visiting Pine and looking to relax with a good brew!” — a [TripAdvisor review](#)

3270 Hwy 87, Pine, AZ 85544 · Mon/Tue/Fri/Sat 11 AM–8 PM, Sun 11 AM–7 PM, closed Wed & Thu · (928) 476-3349 · \$\$ (~\$10–25/person) · Dog-friendly patio with live music; the porch tables go fast on fair afternoons. · [their website](#)

Why the Hearth sends you:

The Hearth sends its guests to THAT Brewery — a brewhouse with the true mead-hall spirit, and ale cold enough to make a Frost Atronach shiver.

TALES FROM THE TREELINE

WARBLE'S STORM SERENADE



Warble warbles, Jethro joins in, and the storm itself applauds.

The thunder rolling over the Rim this fine Tuesday is not, as the bards first feared, the voice of an angry god — it is the storm-song of Warble (a traveling goblin bard), who washed up on the Hearth's front deck this morning with his lute, his hat full of rainwater, and a song that simply could not wait for fair weather.

Warble sang in the goblin tongue, which nobody in the Hold speaks a word of, and it was the prettiest thing anybody had ever heard — a low, rolling warble that rose and fell like the storm itself. Henny, halfway across the deck with her umbrella, stopped mid-step and laid an egg right on the downbeat.

Jethro, never one to let a performance go unjoined, opened his great Mogollon mouth and sang along in what he believes is goblin. It was not goblin. It was, Mabel says, the sound of a pine falling on a tuba — and just as he hit his highest note, the sky answered with a thunderclap so perfectly timed that Jethro bowed, certain the storm itself was applauding.

Warble tipped his rainwater hat to the clouds. Encore, he warbled. The clouds, obliged, thundered.